A FORWARDABLE EXPLAINER

Founder Bottleneck Diagnostic

Last updated September 2026

The short version

You hired good people so the company would depend less on you. It still depends on you. Decisions they were hired to own still land on your desk, and you're starting to wonder if you hired the wrong person.

Maybe you did. Maybe it's the right person in a setup where they can't really own anything. I don't assume which. One 90-minute session finds out what's actually keeping you in the middle. If it's worth fixing, we change it with your leader in the room and check over 30 days whether decisions actually stop coming back.

Who's behind it

I'm Trung. Before this, 10+ years in engineering, mostly infrastructure, including Contentful and Workpath. At Workpath I ran infra, and what my team built there is a big part of why the company could run six product teams shipping at once.

I'm not a coach and I'm not a consultant who does a bit of everything. Systems, theory of constraints, security, infra, that's the background. What I do for a founder now is basically what I used to do for a broken system: find where it's actually stuck, not where it looks stuck.

A peer from that time put it well:

> "Trung excels at seeing the big picture for our team and where we can and should focus our resources. A great sparring partner for any kind of topic."
>
> *Martin, engineering peer at Workpath*

Who it helps

Mostly founders running a real company with a team, who hired a COO, a Head of Ops or a senior lead to get out of the day to day. Or they're about to, and betting the hire fixes it. The team waits for their yes. A week off and things slow down. They tried delegating harder already.

Same thing shows up in other shapes too. Team feels slow, priorities are everywhere, founder's stuck inside their own machine. Most founders walk in sure of the problem, "my team's slow," "marketing isn't working." Usually that's the symptom. We find what's under it.

Probably not for you if you're still at idea stage with no team or product, if you want someone to tell you you're doing fine, or if you're after ongoing coaching. No open-ended retainer. On purpose.

Does it actually work

Fair question, especially if we haven't worked together. A few real ones:

> "Your question-asking approach helped me save 10 to 15 hours of nonsense outreach."
>
> *Minh, founder of Algomate*

> "It's like going to the doctor to get a scan you've never had before and you find out problems you didn't know you had."
>
> *Founder, early-stage public speaking platform (the result landed six months after the session, not the same week)*

> "You are good at laying things out on a table, like a puzzle, putting it together and helping someone articulate and see the next necessary steps. And aside from the clarity, there's always this knowledge, this certainty: we can make it work somehow with this guy, without awkwardness, without any games."
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> *Chris, founder of mindtv (we didn't end up working together, he said this seven months later)*

> "You know that way you already know something, but it hits when someone says it to you straight? Sometimes you just need to take your medicine."
>
> *Johny Harris, founder of Dai Viet Rugby*

> "The investment in clarity is a key to focus, focus is the key to success."
>
> *Alex, founder, working together on and off since the first session*

What you walk out with

Usually: the thing to stop doing, said plainly. One to three real priorities instead of a long list. A decision you'd been sitting on, made. The number you'd been avoiding, finally on the table.

That's basically the whole thing, honestly, not a 40-page plan. If it worked, you should be able to say it back to your co-founder in one sentence.

If it's the hired-leader situation and worth going further, there's a 30 day version: we change who decides what, run the company that way for a month and count what still comes back to you. Then we check whether I was right. The session counts toward it.

How it works

Remote, 90 minutes, €750. Book directly, no call needed first: buy.stripe.com/4gMfZidgA6Y61rebxj38406. Already connected on LinkedIn? DM me "diagnostic" and I'll send the same link.

Know someone this sounds like? Forward it. If it's you, just book it. If it's not a fit once we're in the session, I'll say so.

Live version: iamtrung.com/d/diagnostic-handout